



Part -2

Wings 3D and the GIMP

UV Mapping and Texturing the Airplane

This article continues from the previous one in which we dealt with modelling an airplane. Here we look at UV mapping—making a 2D image of the 3D model.

*W*hy is texturing of a model important? Obviously, a black-and-white rendered outline of a model is far less appealing to the eye than a picture rendered with colour combinations and texturing. If you were to render the plane's model without applying such colouring, it would seem pretty drab. UV mapping and texturing will make it aesthetically more appealing, as we will see. So let's explore texturing the 3D model.

UV mapping and texturing

UV mapping is the procedure of making a 2D image representation of a 3D model. The process of UV mapping is normally used for texturing 3D models; it 'projects' a texture map onto the 3D object. As opposed to the X, Y and Z coordinates (the coordinates for the original 3D object in the modelling space), a different set of coordinates is used to describe the surface of the mesh, denoted by the letters U and V. Therefore, the term 'UV